Nine States Elect History-Making Governors

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On Tuesday, voters in nine states chose **governors** who made history.

In Georgia, Keisha Lance Bottoms will be the first Black woman elected **governor** of any state. In New Mexico, Deb Haaland will be the first **Native American** woman **governor** in U.S. history.

California chose its first elected Latino **governor**, Xavier Becerra. Texas chose its first **Latina governor**, Gina Hinojosa the first Democrat to win that job in Texas in more than 30 years.

Florida and Wisconsin elected their first Black **governors**: Byron Donalds in Florida and David Crowley in Wisconsin.

Three states elected a woman **governor** for the first time: Marsha Blackburn in Tennessee, Amy Klobuchar in Minnesota and Amy Acton in Ohio. Acton will also be Ohio's first **Jewish governor**.

Across the country, these races changed the picture of who can lead a state.

Word Treasure

governor -- The elected leader of one U.S. state, like a president for that state.

Latina -- A woman whose family comes from Latin America, where Spanish or Portuguese is spoken.

Native American -- A member of the peoples who lived in the Americas long before Europeans arrived.

Jewish -- Belonging to the Jewish people or the religion of Judaism.

Background you need

A governor is the leader of one state, like a president for that state.

These nine winners are the first people of their kind to win the job in their states.

That is why Tuesday was a history-making day.

Break it down

WHO: Voters in nine states
WHAT: They elected governors who are historic firsts for their states
WHERE: In states including Georgia, New Mexico, California, Texas, Florida and Wisconsin
WHY: Voters picked new leaders, and many of the winners broke barriers in their states

Why it matters

Governors help run the state you live in, so who wins can change things like schools and roads near your home.

Test what you remember

1. How many states chose history-making governors?

(A) Fifty
(B) Two
(C) One
(D) Nine

2. Who will be the first Black woman elected governor of any state?

(A) Gina Hinojosa
(B) Keisha Lance Bottoms
(C) Amy Acton
(D) Deb Haaland

3. Which state chose its first Latina governor?

(A) Florida
(B) Texas
(C) Ohio
(D) Georgia

4. Deb Haaland will be the first what?

(A) First mayor of her city
(B) First Native American woman governor in U.S. history
(C) First senator from her state
(D) First Jewish governor

5. Which two states elected their first Black governors?

(A) Tennessee and Minnesota
(B) Florida and Wisconsin
(C) Ohio and Georgia
(D) Texas and California

6. Amy Acton will also be Ohio's first what?

(A) Jewish governor
(B) Latino governor
(C) Youngest governor
(D) Woman mayor

Answer key (try the quiz first!): 1: D 2: B 3: B 4: B 5: B 6: A

Questions to think about

MY THOUGHTS (at least 20 words):